



REMEDIATION PLAN

VIRTUAL CONTROL
VMWARE CLOUD FOUNDATION SOLUTIONS

Post-vCenter-Redeploy Remediation Plan

Sequenced, approval-gated plan to clear the remaining SDDC Manager activation, NSX inventory, and VM web console fallout from the vCenter certificate / SSO / host-key regeneration.

SDDC MANAGER

VCENTER ACTIVATING

NSX INVENTORY

SERVICE ACCOUNTS

VM CONSOLE

VCF 9.0

VMware Cloud Foundation

Post-vCenter-Redeploy Remediation Plan — SDDC Manager Activation, NSX Inventory, VM Web Console

Prepared by: Virtual Control LLC **Date:** June 5, 2026 **Document Version:** 1.0 **Classification:** Internal **Platform:** VMware Cloud Foundation 9.0

Scope. A sequenced, approval-gated plan to correct the three remaining issues that trace back to the management vCenter regeneration (machine SSL / VMCA cert, SSO, and SSH host key all changed): (1) vCenter stuck `ACTIVATING` in SDDC Manager, (2) NSX missing from SDDC Manager inventory, (3) the VM web console failing for all VMs. Each issue is presented with verified facts, the Broadcom-prescribed remediation, read-only verification gates, risk, and an escalation point. **No change is executed without a read-only confirmation and explicit approval first.**

Companion docs. - [VCF-Operations-Integration-Trust-Repair-After-vCenter-Cert-Regen-2026-06-05.md](#) — completed VCF Operations adapter repair - [SDDC-Manager-UI-Stuck-Initializing-vCenter-SSH-HostKey-Repair-KB316028-2026-06-05.md](#) — completed SDDC Manager UI repair

Table of Contents

- 1. Common Root Cause & What Is Already Fixed
- 2. Current Verified State
- 3. Guardrails (Apply to Every Step)
- 4. Issue 1 — vCenter Stuck `ACTIVATING`
- 5. Issue 2 — NSX Missing From SDDC Inventory
- 6. Issue 3 — VM Web Console Fails for All VMs
- 7. Execution Sequence
- 8. Escalation — When to Open a Broadcom SR
- 9. Document Information

1. Common Root Cause and What Is Already Fixed

All open items descend from one event: the **management vCenter was regenerated** (VMCA root CA ~2026-05-10, machine SSL leaf ~2026-05-13), which simultaneously changed its **certificate**, **SSO**, and **SSH host key**. Every management component that had a trusted relationship with vCenter broke in its own way.

Component	Symptom	Status
VCF Operations — vCenter & vSAN adapters	"Unable to connect to VC"	✅ Fixed (cert re-trust + vSAN re-add)

Component	Symptom	Status
SDDC Manager UI	Stuck "VMware Cloud Foundation is initializing"	✅ Fixed (SSH host-key refresh, KB 316028)
SDDC Manager scheduler	SoS / periodic tasks dormant	✅ Fixed (full <code>sddcmanager_restart_services.sh</code>)
SDDC Manager — vCenter object	ACTIVATING (will not clear)	⌚ Issue 1
SDDC Manager — NSX inventory	<code>nsxt-clusters</code> count 0, orphaned domain reference	⌚ Issue 2
vCenter — VM web console	Fails for all VMs	⌚ Issue 3

2. Current Verified State

Captured read-only via SDDC Manager API (`https://192.168.1.241`) and direct probes:

Fact	Value
<code>/v1/vcenters/status</code>	<code>vcenter.lab.local</code> → ACTIVATING (id <code>54faaaaf-...</code>)
<code>/v1/domains</code>	<code>mgmt</code> → ACTIVE ; references <code>nsxtCluster</code> id <code>c278c693-...</code> / <code>nsx-vip.lab.local</code>
<code>/v1/nsxt-clusters</code>	count 0 (the referenced cluster is not enumerated)
Depot status	<code>DEPOT_CONNECTION_SUCCESSFUL</code>
In-flight task	"Downloading Esx metadata, vib and vendor add-ons" — <code>IN_PROGRESS</code> (no subtasks, long-running)
Failed scheduled task (06-03)	Credentials rotate — vCenter SSO <code>svc-sddc-manager-vcenter-4598@vsphere.local</code> = " <i>provided credentials are invalid</i> "; NSX <code>svc-sddc-manager-nsx-vip-9971</code> = " <i>no route to host</i> " (the VIP <code>.70</code> was unset then; restored 2026-06-05)
vCenter reachability	443 + 22 open; UI 200; API 401 (alive)

3. Guardrails (Apply to Every Step)

- Read-only first.** Every mutating step is preceded by a read-only check that confirms the specific root cause. If the check does not confirm the cause, stop — do not execute the change.
- Approval gate.** No service-account remediation, task cancellation, inventory edit, or service restart runs without explicit go-ahead.
- Snapshot before service-account / inventory changes.** SDDC Manager snapshot taken from vSphere Client before Issue 1 step C and Issue 2.
- Broadcom-prescribed path only.** Follow the cited KB verbatim. **No direct SDDC Manager / vCenter database edits** unless a KB explicitly directs it.
- One change at a time, re-verify after each.** Do not stack changes; confirm effect before the next.

6. Fragile single-host nested platform — interlocked dependencies; never restart a host/mgmt VM or touch uplinks/MM as a side effect.

4. Issue 1 — vCenter Stuck ACTIVATING

Working diagnosis. The full services restart resolved the dormant scheduler. The domain will transition `ACTIVATING` → `ACTIVE` once the in-flight "Downloading Esx metadata" task completes (per **KB 407866**, a stuck/failed personality/metadata download is the classic cause of a domain stuck `ACTIVATING`). A secondary candidate is the stale vCenter SSO service account (`svc-sddc-manager-vcenter-4598`) from the 06-03 rotation failure. Neither is yet *confirmed* as the blocker.

Reference KBs: 407866 (stuck `ACTIVATING`), 381321 / 314177 (service-account remediation), 314643 (recreate service account).

Step 1A — Let the in-flight download complete (no change; monitoring)

- Watch the "Downloading Esx metadata, vibx and vendor add-ons" task to a terminal state and watch `/v1/vcenters` status.
- **Pass:** task → `SUCCESSFUL` and vCenter → `ACTIVE` . **Issue 1 closed.**
- **If task** → `FAILED` : capture the subtask error → go to Step 1B.
- **If task stays** `IN_PROGRESS` > **60 min**: treat as hung → go to Step 1B.

Step 1B — Confirm cause via SoS services-health (read-only diagnostic)

- Run `/opt/vmware/sddc-support/sos --services-health --domain-name ALL` on SDDC Manager.
- Note: SoS pre-validation refuses to run while a workflow is "in a transitional state," so this may require Step 1A's task to be terminal first.
- Use the output to decide between the depot/personality-download path (Step 1C-i) and the service-account path (Step 1C-ii).

Step 1C — Remediate the confirmed cause (approval-gated)

- **1C-i (download/personality):** if the download failed with a depot/URL/credential error, correct the LCM depot configuration per KB 407866 (and KB 390121 / 389871) and **retry** the download. Re-verify vCenter status.
- **1C-ii (service account):** if SoS / Password Management shows `svc-sddc-manager-vcenter-4598@vsphere.local` `Disconnected/invalid`:
- **Snapshot SDDC Manager.**
- SDDC Manager UI → **Administration** → **Security** → **Password Management** → select the account → **Remediate** with the valid password (KB 381321 / 314177).
- **Caveat (KB 381321):** if the vCenter SSO password policy yields an expiry beyond `9999-12-31` , remediation fails with a Postgres "timestamp out of range" error — lower the SSO password-expiration policy to a finite value first.
- If the account no longer exists on the redeployed vCenter SSO, recreate it per KB 314643 / 314177, then remediate.
- **Re-verify:** `/v1/vcenters` → `ACTIVE` ; a Health-Check task runs and succeeds.

Risk: Low for 1A/1B (read-only / monitoring). Medium for 1C (snapshot first; supported UI remediation).

5. Issue 2 — NSX Missing From SDDC Inventory

Working diagnosis. The NSX Manager was rebuilt outside the SDDC Manager workflow. SDDC Manager's `mgmt` domain still references NSX cluster `c278c693-... / nsx-vip.lab.local`, but `/v1/nsxt-clusters` enumerates zero clusters — an orphaned/inconsistent inventory reference. The 06-03 NSX credential rotation also failed ("no route to host"), but that was because the NSX VIP `.70` was unset at the time; **the VIP was restored 2026-06-05**, so that path may now succeed.

Reference KBs: 421607 (NSX not visible / marked ERROR in SDDC), 316043 (NSX disconnected in Password Management), 314608 (the originating "missing VCF component NSX" finding).

Step 2A — Read-only confirmation

- Confirm `nsx-vip.lab.local` (`192.168.1.70`) is now reachable from SDDC Manager (TCP 443; API responds).
- Re-pull `/v1/nsxt-clusters` and the `nsx-vip` entry in Password Management; record whether the NSX service account shows Disconnected vs absent.

Step 2B — Re-establish the SDDC ↔ NSX handshake (approval-gated)

- Now that the VIP is restored, **Remediate** the NSX service account (`svc-sddc-manager-nsx-vip-9971`) via **Administration** → **Security** → **Password Management** (KB 316043) — this is the lightest supported action and may repopulate inventory.
- Re-check `/v1/nsxt-clusters`.

Step 2C — Inventory reconciliation (only if 2B does not repopulate)

- If the domain still references an NSX cluster that the inventory does not enumerate, this is an orphaned-reference reconciliation. **Do not hand-edit the SDDC Manager database.** Pursue the KB 421607 path (status correction) **only under Broadcom guidance**, or open a Broadcom SR.

Risk: Medium for 2B (supported remediation). High for 2C (inventory/DB territory) — SR preferred.

6. Issue 3 — VM Web Console Fails for All VMs

Working diagnosis (unconfirmed — not yet investigated). The HTML5 / WebMKS VM console proxies through vCenter and depends on the vCenter certificate the browser and the console proxy trust. The vCenter cert regeneration is the most likely cause; a browser-cached old cert or a console-proxy service needing the new cert are common contributors.

Step 3A — Read-only diagnosis

- Reproduce from a clean browser session (rule out cached cert/thumbprint).
- Confirm whether the console fails at ticket acquisition (vCenter) or at the ESXi WebMKS connection.
- Check vCenter service health for the console/UI proxy (`vmware-vsphere-ui` , `vmware-rhttpproxy`) read-only.
- Identify the exact Broadcom KB for "VM web console fails after vCenter certificate replacement."

Step 3B — Apply the prescribed fix (approval-gated)

- Likely candidates (to be confirmed by 3A + the KB): restart the vCenter UI / console-proxy service, or re-trust the new vCenter certificate where the console path validates it.
- Re-verify by opening a VM console.

Risk: Low–Medium (browser cache is zero-risk; a vCenter UI-service restart is low-impact and does not affect running VMs).

7. Execution Sequence

Recommended order (each gated by its own read-only confirmation + approval):

1. **Issue 1, Step 1A** — finish watching the in-flight download (in progress now). Most likely closes Issue 1 with no change.
2. **Issue 3** — can run in parallel; it is independent of SDDC Manager activation and the safest to investigate.
3. **Issue 1, Steps 1B/1C** — only if 1A does not clear `ACTIVATING` .
4. **Issue 2** — after Issue 1 is settled (NSX inventory work is the most fragile; do it last and with the domain healthy).

Rationale: Issue 1A is already underway and low-risk; Issue 3 is independent and low-risk; Issue 2 is the highest-risk (inventory) and benefits from a fully healthy domain first.

8. Escalation — When to Open a Broadcom SR

Open a support request rather than improvise if any of the following hold:

- vCenter remains `ACTIVATING` after the download completes **and** service-account remediation succeeds (Issue 1 exhausted).
- The NSX inventory still shows an orphaned reference after the service-account remediation (Issue 2C) — DB-level reconciliation should be Broadcom-guided.
- Any step would require a direct SDDC Manager / vCenter database edit not explicitly directed by a KB.

Capture for the SR: SoS health bundle (`/opt/vmware/sddc-support/sos`), the failed task IDs/errors, and this plan.

9. Document Information

Field	Value
Title	Post-vCenter-Redeploy Remediation Plan — SDDC Manager Activation, NSX Inventory, VM Web Console

Field	Value
Document ID	VC-PLAN-POSTREDEPLOY-REMEDIATION-20260605
Version	1.0
Issued	2026-06-05
Author	Virtual Control LLC
Classification	Internal
Platform	VMware Cloud Foundation 9.0
Applies to	Residual SDDC Manager / NSX inventory / VM console issues after a management vCenter regeneration
Primary references	Broadcom KB 407866, 381321, 314177, 314643, 421607, 316043, 314608
Related Documents	VCF Operations Integration Trust Repair (2026-06-05); SDDC Manager UI Stuck Initializing — SSH Host-Key Repair (2026-06-05)
Distribution	Lab notebook

Revision History

Version	Date	Notes
1.0	2026-06-05	Initial plan. Common root cause, current verified state, guardrails, and per-issue read-only → prescribed-fix → verify → escalate steps for vCenter ACTIVATING, NSX inventory, and the VM web console, with an execution sequence and SR criteria.

Document End

See also: - VCF Operations Integration Trust Repair After vCenter Certificate Regeneration (2026-06-05) - SDDC Manager UI Stuck on "VMware Cloud Foundation is Initializing" — vCenter SSH Host-Key Repair (KB 316028) (2026-06-05)